

Vault Operations Manual

Chapter I: Skills

A vault dweller has seven skills: Athletics, Barter, Lockpick, Medicine, Melee, Science and Survival. Each skill is rated from one to six, and a rating of three is considered competent for day to day work inside the vault. Skills are tested by rolling against the rating, and the overseer may call for a test whenever the outcome of an action is uncertain.

Athletics covers climbing, swimming and running. Barter covers haggling with traders at the vault door. Lockpick covers mechanical locks but not electronic terminals, which fall under Science. Medicine covers first aid and the treatment of radiation sickness. Melee covers close combat with improvised weapons. Survival covers foraging in the wastes above.

Chapter II: Perks

Perks are chosen at level up, one perk per level, and may not be taken twice unless the perk says otherwise. The Gunslinger perk improves pistol accuracy at close range. The Pack Rat perk raises carrying capacity by ten pounds. The Iron Stomach perk removes the penalty for eating spoiled food.

A perk may have a prerequisite skill rating. Gunslinger requires a Melee rating of two or better, which surprises most dwellers, because the perk is named for pistols rather than for fists or clubs or knives.

Chapter III: Radiation

Radiation damage is permanent until treated with RadAway. Exposure above two hundred rads is lethal without treatment, and exposure above fifty rads causes lasting fatigue. A dweller carries a personal dosimeter that records cumulative exposure across every excursion beyond the vault door.

RadAway is stocked in the vault clinic and is dispensed by the doctor on request. RadX taken in advance reduces the rads absorbed during a trip to the surface, but it does nothing for rads already absorbed.